

The Sūtra of the Ten Buddhas

Daśabuddhaka nāma mahāyānasūtra · Toh 272 · Derge Kangyur

སངས་རྒྱལ་བཅ་ཏུ་ཞེས་བརྒྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མཛད་

The Ten Buddhas, known in Sanskrit as the Daśabuddhaka and in Tibetan as Sangyé Chupa, is a Mahāyāna sūtra concerned with the veneration and qualities of ten buddhas. It is Toh 272 in the Kangyur, belonging to the general category of Mahāyāna sūtras. The text opens with a familiar canonical setting — the Buddha dwelling on Vulture Peak near Rājagṛha — and is prompted by the bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, a young Licchavi from Vaiśālī, who rises to address the Blessed One before an assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. The sūtra thus unfolds as a teaching delivered in response to a question or entreaty from this bodhisattva, centering on the significance and invocation of ten buddhas.

In the language of India: Daśabuddhakaṃ nāma mahāyānasūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Sūtra of the Great Vehicle called "The Ten Buddhas."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, together with a Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks and with many tens of thousands of great bodhisattvas.

At that time, in that very assembly, there was present the great bodhisattva from Vaiśālī, a young Licchavi, named Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower.

Then the great bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, turned toward the Blessed One, joined his palms, and bowed. He then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "If it would please the Blessed One to hear our request, I would ask the Blessed One — the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha — something on behalf of our party."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the great bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower: "Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, ask the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha whatever you wish. I will satisfy your mind by prophesying concerning each thing you ask."

Then the great bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, are there any blessed ones — Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — presently dwelling, living, and teaching the Dharma in other world-systems, by holding in mind whose names a son or daughter of good family might swiftly reach perfect, complete awakening, the unsurpassed and perfect enlightenment?"

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the great bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower: "Excellent! Excellent! Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, it is very good that you, who have come here in this way together with the assembled great bodhisattvas, and motivated by compassion for the world, have thought to put this question in full to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha, for the sake, benefit, and happiness of the bodhisattvas, the gods, humans, and the multitude of beings gathered here. Therefore, Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, listen carefully, take this to heart, and I shall explain it to you."

"So be it, Blessed One," said the great bodhisattva Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, and he listened attentively to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One then declared: "Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the eastern direction there exists a world-system called All-Qualities-Perfectly-Pure. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Qualities-Surpassing-Immeasurable-Aeons presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called Thoroughly-Gathered-and-Accumulated. The lifespan of the sentient beings there is immeasurable. All the retinue of the Blessed One Qualities-Surpassing-Immeasurable-Aeons are exclusively those who have genuinely entered the Great Vehicle."

"If a son or daughter of noble family retains the name of that Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Qualities-Surpassing-Immeasurable-Aeons, they will turn their back on cyclic existence for sixty thousand aeons. After passing away they will attain a dhāraṇī called Unobscured. The blessed buddhas of ten billion buddha fields will inspire them with genuine confidence. When they teach the Dharma, they will never become exhausted. Concerning this, it is said:

Whoever holds the name of that Protector
will easily find supreme awakening,
and will attain the other qualities of the Sugata
and these stainless qualities."

"Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the southern direction there exists a world-system called Jewel-Qualities-Arrayed. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Glorious-Splendor-of-the-Aggregate-of-Aeons-of-Jewel-Qualities-Arrayed presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called Vast Qualities.

If a son or daughter of noble family retains the name of that Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Glorious-Splendor-of-the-Aggregate-of-Aeons-of-Jewel-Qualities-Arrayed, after passing away they will attain a meditative absorption called Boundless-Light-of-the-Solar-Disc. They will come to encompass immeasurable buddha fields in their purview. In whatever buddha field they have made aspiration prayers, in that very field they will be reborn. They will be just one birth away from unsurpassed, perfectly and completely awakening. After passing away, they will also attain the thirty-two marks of a great being. Concerning this, it is said:

Whoever holds this all-pervading name
will attain at death a boundless meditative absorption
whose light is that of the solar disc,
together with the major marks."

"Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the western direction there exists a world-system called Completely-Free-from-All-Darkness-through-Effort. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Glorious-Confidence-Arrayed-in-All-Dharmas presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called Arrangement-of-the-Śākya-Kings.

If a son or daughter of noble family retains the name of that Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Glorious-Confidence-Arrayed-in-All-Dharmas, they will not meet their death by weapons, fire, water, or poison, and they will be born through miraculous birth. After passing away, they will attain a meditative absorption called Hundredfold-Power. Concerning this, it is said:

Whoever holds the name of that Victor
will not die by fire, water, or poison,
weapons will not harm them, and being learned,
they will not be born in a womb — such a person will attain dhāraṇīs."

"Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the northern direction there exists a world-system called Free-from-Darkness-and-Dust. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Perfectly-Practicing-Immeasurable-Confidence-Arrayed presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called the Precious."

If a son or daughter of good family holds the name of that Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Perfectly-Practicing-Immeasurable-Confidence-Arrayed, they will delight sixty trillion buddhas. They will attain the dhāraṇī called Following-After-All. They will attain the meditative absorption called Definite-Emergence-from-What-Is-Like-an-Illusion. They will attain the meditative absorption called the Inexhaustible-Treasure-Basket. Until they become an unsurpassably, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, they will never be born in or wander through the three lower realms. In whatever buddha-field they are born, they will fully liberate all sentient beings who have gone to the lower realms, and they will establish all of those beings in irreversibility from unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. Concerning this, it is said:

Whoever holds the name of that Sugata
will arouse awakening in boundless sentient beings,
will attain dhāraṇīs and meditative absorptions,
and will not be frightened by birth in the lower realms.

Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the southeastern direction there exists a world-system called Long-Abiding-in-Happiness-Arrayed. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Thousandfold-Voiced-Thunder-of-the-Clouds presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called Arising-of-Qualities.

If a son or daughter of good family holds the name of that Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Thousandfold-Voiced-Thunder-of-the-Clouds, then after passing from this life they will attain the four individual and perfect cognitions. They will attain the four fearlessnesses. They will attain great loving-kindness and great

compassion. They will attain the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha. They will attain buddha-field qualities arrayed like that of the world-system Sukhāvātī of the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha. And women too, after passing from this life, will attain a male birth and will be reborn to behold the face of the Blessed One, a buddha. Concerning this, it is said:

Whoever holds these names
will attain fields like that of Amitābha,
women will be transformed into men — these inconceivable
qualities and yet others will also be attained.

Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower, in the southwestern direction there exists a world-system called Immeasurable-Qualities-Arrayed. There, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Arising-of-the-Splendor-and-Majesty-of-the-Supreme-Light-of-the-Sun presently dwells, lives, and teaches the Dharma. That aeon is called Perfectly-Producing-Mental-Ease.

If a son or daughter of good family hears the names of that Blessed One, that Tathāgata, that arhat, that perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Arising-of-the-Splendor-and-Majesty-of-the-Supreme-Light-of-the-Sun, by the mere hearing of those names they will delight countless buddhas. They will attain the meditative absorption called Everywhere-Like-Brilliance. And if a son or daughter of good family holds those names continuously, after passing from this life they will establish all sentient beings in the meditative absorption called Everywhere-Like-Brilliance, and all of them will be made certain of unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. Now one might ask: through what cause and condition will all sentient beings attain the meditative absorption called Everywhere-Like-Brilliance and be made certain of unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening?

Any son or daughter of good family who abides in this meditative absorption and teaches the Dharma: by virtue of having taught the Dharma in that way, they will attain this meditative absorption, and all the sentient beings of that great trichiliocosm — however many there may be — will likewise come to well-being. Just as, for example, in the pure land of the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha called Pleasing to the Mind, sentient beings are established solely in well-being, those beings who have gone to the lower realms are completely liberated and made to attain the essential nature of

gods and humans, and all of them are made certain of unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening — so it is here.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever holds the name of that protector
will reflect with thought not directed outward,
will attain the meditative absorption like brilliance,
and will give rise to many others from it as well.

In the northwest direction from Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming, there is a world system called Free from Lower Realms. There abides at this very time the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha called Splendor Arising, the King of Majesty in Many Aspects, living and remaining and teaching the Dharma. That eon is named Vast Virtue.

If a son or daughter of good family holds the name of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha called Splendor Arising, the King of Majesty in Many Aspects, then after passing from this life they will attain the dhāraṇī called Arrangement of Immeasurable Courage. With slight effort they will perfectly retain the excellent qualities of the pure land of the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha Amitābha. In a single lifetime they will attain unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. And they will hear the Dharma taught by nine hundred million buddhas.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever holds that Victor's name
will attain awakening in a single lifetime,
pure lands equal to that of Amitābha,
and a dhāraṇī — that sentient being will attain all this.

In the northeast direction from Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming, there is a world system called Free from Every Harm of Sorrow. There abides at this very time the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha called Ever-Arising throughout Countless Millions of Eons, living and remaining and teaching the Dharma. That eon is named Arrangement of Courage.

If a son or daughter of good family holds the name of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, Arhat, and Perfectly Enlightened Buddha called Ever-Arising throughout Countless Millions of Eons, then after passing from this life they will attain excellent eloquence endowed with sixty branches of melodious voice. They will give rise to roots of virtue in the presence of eight hundred million

buddhas.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever holds those Victors' names
will, through merit not lesser in measure
than venerating eighty billion trillion Victors,
attain excellent melodious speech endowed with sixty branches.

In the direction above Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming, there is a world system called Arrangement of Immeasurable Splendor.

There dwells at present the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Arrangement of Splendor Arising from Virtue Proclaimed Throughout the Golden Sky, living and teaching the Dharma. That eon is known as Exceedingly Clear Light. Should a son or daughter of good family hold the name of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Arrangement of Splendor Arising from Virtue Proclaimed Throughout the Golden Sky, they will purify an immeasurable aggregate of moral discipline, an immeasurable aggregate of meditative absorption, an immeasurable aggregate of wisdom, an immeasurable aggregate of liberation, and an immeasurable aggregate of the wisdom-vision of liberation. They will progress from ground to ground. They will attain the supreme wisdom that transcends the world and surpasses it. They will attain the power of kinship and sovereignty. They will attain unshakeable confidence. They will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. All sentient beings will attain knowledge of death and transmigration, recollection of former lives, and understanding of all languages. They will attain unceasing eloquence. They will attain high birth. They will attain great lineage. They will recall their past lives. They will attain the five higher knowledges and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever holds those buddha-names
will be endowed with all excellences of every kind,
will not long be delayed in attaining noble awakening,
and will achieve wisdom unsurpassed among all the worlds.

In the direction below Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming, there is a world system called All Dust Assembled. There dwells at present the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Splendor Arising

from the Magical Display of the Mode of All Phenomena, living and teaching the Dharma. That eon is known as All Worlds Accumulated. Should a son or daughter of good family hold the name of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha called Splendor Arising from the Magical Display of the Mode of All Phenomena, they will attain the dhāraṇī called Moon. Within a single lifetime they will attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. They will hear the Dharma taught by nine hundred billion buddhas, and having heard it, they will retain it all entirely.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Whoever holds the name of that protector
will retain the Dharma of billions of buddhas,
and within a single lifetime will attain noble awakening
and this dhāraṇī called Moon.

Thereupon the great bodhisattva Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming and the great bodhisattva All Qualities Delightful attained the dhāraṇī. Eighty billion bodhisattvas came to abide in the state of non-regression. Countless tens of thousands of gods and humans gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed awakening.

The Blessed One, joyful, spoke these words, and addressed the great bodhisattva Jewel-and-Flower Abundantly Blooming, the great bodhisattva All Qualities Delightful, the bodhisattvas, and

the monks. The worlds of gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and took great delight in what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra called The Ten Buddhas.

Translated from Sanskrit by the Indian paṇḍita Prajñā

Translator's Notes

- The bodhisattva's name, rendered here as "Qualities-Precious-Blossoming-Flower," translates the Tibetan Yon tan rin chen me tog rgyas pa, which appears to be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name such as Guṇaratnapuṣpavikasita or similar. The translation is semantic and consistent throughout.

The phrase rendered "by holding in mind whose names" translates mtshan bzung na, literally "if one holds the name," a standard formulation in buddha-name sūtras indicating the meditational recollection of a buddha's name as a soteriological act.

- The name of the western buddha's aeon, rendered here as "Arrangement-of-the-Śākya-Kings," translates the Tibetan Śākyai rgyal po bkod pa literally. It may refer to an arrangement or array of kings of the Śākya lineage, which is an unusual

aeon-name. No Sanskrit source has been checked to confirm; the rendering follows the literal Tibetan.

The phrase rendered "just one birth away from unsurpassed, perfectly and completely awakening" translates *skye ba gcig gis thogs so*, meaning they are separated from buddhahood by only a single birth — a standard Mahāyāna formulation for a bodhisattva on the final ground.

- The term rendered "four individual and perfect cognitions" translates "so so yang dag par rig pa bzhi," referring to the four pratisamṃvids — the four analytical knowledges of Dharma, meaning, language, and ready speech — a standard set of four cognitive excellences attributed to fully awakened beings. This standard doctrinal set is here listed as a benefit of holding the buddha's name, which is noteworthy.

The phrase "women will be transformed into men" renders "bud med phor 'gyur," a traditional formulation reflecting the classical Indian Buddhist view that a female rebirth is considered less conducive to certain stages of the path; this is presented here as a soteriological benefit within the text's own frame.

- The phrase rendered "reflect with thought not directed outward" translates "正思惟於內觀" literally as "one engages in contemplation that is not external." This likely means non-discursive or inward-directed meditation, possibly referencing a specific absorption practice. The precise technical nuance is not fully transparent from context alone.

The epithet "सुप्रसन्नोऽसौ भगवन्" is rendered "Splendor Arising, the King of Majesty in Many Aspects" as a working translation of an otherwise unattested buddha name; the rendering is reasonable but the exact canonical Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain.

- The five higher knowledges (mngon par shes pa lnga) are the standard set: supernormal powers, divine eye, divine ear, knowledge of others' minds, and recollection of former lives. The eighteen unshared qualities (sangs rgyas kyi chos ma 'dres pa bco bryad) are qualities exclusive to a fully awakened buddha. These are well-established Abhidharma enumerations and need no further comment.

The phrase rendered "power of kinship and sovereignty" translates *gnyen gyi stobs dang rgyal srid 'thob par 'gyur ro* — literally "attaining the power of kinship and royal dominion." The pairing is slightly unusual; it may refer to noble family connections and temporal authority as fruits of merit, which is a recognized category in such lists.

- The text ends mid-sentence with the colophon beginning to name the translator — the Indian paṇḍita Prajñā — but the passage breaks off before the full colophon is given. This is likely Prajñā (Skt. Prajñā), the late eighth to early ninth century Kashmiri monk active at the Tibetan court, but the name is cut short so certainty is not possible.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.